

GERALD O'RILEY

SENIOR QUALITY ENGINEERING & DELIVERY LEAD | AUTOMATION | RELEASE GOVERNANCE

Yorkville, IL • 630-303-0794 • Jerr.oriley@gmail.com • jerryoriley.com • linkedin.com/in/gerald-oriley

Quality engineering and delivery leader with 18 years of IT experience improving complex enterprise and regulated FinTech systems from requirements through production. Combines hands-on manual, API, data, automation, and observability depth with functional leadership, release governance, risk-based decision making, mentoring, and a record of turning under-documented products into measurable, repeatable quality practices.

CORE EXPERTISE

Quality Strategy & Ownership • Playwright / TypeScript • Cypress / Selenium • REST / SOAP APIs • SQL • Azure DevOps / CI/CD • AWS EC2 / Azure • Splunk / New Relic • Jira / Confluence • TestRail / Testiny • AI-Assisted Testing • Release & Defect Leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PAYROC | Senior QA Engineer II / Quality Owner | 2020-2026

- Served as primary quality owner across multiple acquired and business-critical FinTech applications, defining test strategy, release criteria, evidence, risk, and final QA signoff while aligning Product, Engineering, DevOps, DBA, vendors, Support, and business stakeholders.
- Reviewed 60-80 changes annually for requirements traceability, test completeness, integration and customer impact, compliance, dependencies, and production readiness; challenged insufficient evidence and supported go/no-go, staged activation, hot-fix, and rollback decisions.
- Helped scale Fidano to approximately 2,000 active cases with about 85% automated coverage using Playwright/TypeScript and Cypress; archived roughly 2,000 classic-view cases after a product refresh and reduced full regression from more than one week to roughly 1-2 hours.
- Helped design and evolve automation using page objects, fixtures, reusable business functions, environment configuration, tagging, and reporting; reviewed pull requests, suggested maintainability and coverage improvements, and retained targeted manual testing for new and high-risk behavior.
- Built REST/SOAP coverage with Postman, including 250+ ACheck21 API tests created where no collections existed; validated end-to-end flows, transformations, permissions, statuses, errors, negative and boundary cases, and SQL-backed outcomes.
- Used SQL extensively to locate and create test data, validate backend state, and reconcile complex workflows across merchant onboarding, underwriting, equipment, ACH/check conversion, settlement, billing, commissions, chargebacks, reporting, and customer portals.
- Integrated production-critical automation into Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines as pre-cutover quality gates for blue-green deployments across AWS EC2 and Azure-hosted products; supported rollback, production smoke testing, and operational-readiness decisions.
- Used Splunk and New Relic to search logs and dashboards, monitor scheduled jobs, compare response behavior, investigate failures, and distinguish software defects from data, dependency, integration, environment, configuration, and user-input problems.
- Used OpenAI tools, Claude, Copilot, and the internal AiDen LLM to critique test plans, compare outputs, identify missed coverage and flaky behavior, generate and review test code, validate requirements, and improve documentation with deliberate human verification.
- Helped win an internal hackathon by defining and validating an LLM-based sensitive-information detection agent that inspected application submissions and prevented more than 100 attempted private-data exposures.
- Administered TestRail and Testiny for 3+ years and helped lead migration of cases, steps, data, and snapshots; verified integrity, standardized Smoke/UAT Critical/Prod Critical labels, and helped save more than \$30K annually.
- Mentored QA professionals from junior through staff level, facilitated learning sessions, participated in interviews, reviewed test evidence and automation code, and helped prioritize releases around customer value, risk, dependencies, and partner commitments.
- Automated headless validation for 280+ application instances during a data-center migration, identifying approximately 30 incomplete migrations and replacing a prior six-person, eight-hour manual verification effort.

AT&T | Senior Specialist Application Developer / CAST Technical Lead | 2008-2020

- Scaled enterprise CAST analysis from 30+ to 230+ applications; built Jenkins-driven source ingestion, database-metadata extraction, snapshot generation, and architecture/quality dashboards while improving turnaround by more than 70% and presenting application results to vice-presidential leadership.
- Partnered with application and vendor teams across multiple technology stacks to investigate code quality, complexity, architecture, security, standards, test coverage, and performance findings; trained staff and onboarded applications and new team members.

AT&T | Defect Manager (concurrent responsibilities) | approximately 2009-2012

- Led defect and release coordination for cross-functional teams of roughly 20 across QA, Development, Requirements, Product, DBA, Production, and infrastructure; assigned work, managed dependencies and capacity, facilitated triage and status meetings, escalated blockers, and drove issues through closure.

EDUCATION & ADDITIONAL TECHNOLOGY

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | Lewis University • Git / GitHub • Postman / Bruno • Oracle • k6 / JMeter familiarity • Docker, GraphQL & microservices familiarity • JAWS Accessibility • Agile / Scrum